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6 October 2026

Graduate Recruitment Team

Albourne Partners

London

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Investment Due Diligence Associate Analyst role in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Albourne's work advising more than 270 investors on hedge fund and private market allocations would let me study hundreds of investment processes rather than one.

My academic work centres on a question asset managers answer every day: what is a return worth once its risk is understood? I tested CAPM on 694 anomaly portfolios across 54 countries and found it fails jointly in 48 of 53, with momentum and value earning the most persistent alphas. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, asks whether governments that hedge oil change how their currencies react to OPEC news, through Norway's krone conversions, Russia's 2017–22 budget rule and Mexico's put hedge, and whether any oil risk that remains is worth trading after costs, a question that matters to any portfolio with commodity or currency exposure.

Asset management appeals to me because it rewards a process that holds up over years rather than a single good call, and because the money belongs to people relying on that process. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC and published weekly research notes for members from outside finance. That work taught me that a sound view is only half the job; it also has to be explained clearly to the people who rely on it.

Albourne stands out to me because its analysts assess hedge fund and private market managers on behalf of institutional investors, and its flat structure, with more than 100 partners, gives junior staff real exposure to that research. My CAPM study taught me how rarely an apparent alpha survives proper testing, and manager due diligence is the professional version of that question: whether a fund's edge is real, repeatable and worth its fees.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan